Digital Literacy Awareness

Name: Jitesh Maru
Registration Number: 25BAI10649
Branch: Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning (AIML)
Year: First Year
Course Code: AIML – CSA2001
Course Name: Digital Literacy – CSE0001
Date: 29 March 2026

Introduction

Digital technology has become an essential part of modern education and communication. Students today must understand how to use digital tools effectively, communicate professionally online, and protect themselves from cyber threats. This project focuses on developing digital literacy skills through practical activities such as creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, exploring coding platforms, learning professional email communication, and understanding cybercrime awareness. Each task helps develop important digital competencies required for academic success and future careers. By completing these activities, students gain hands-on experience with modern tools such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Forms, and coding practice platforms. The project also highlights the importance of safe internet practices and responsible digital behavior. Overall, these activities encourage students to build a strong digital presence while improving their technical, communication, and cybersecurity awareness skills.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. Canva is an online design platform that provides templates, icons, and visual elements that allow users to design professional graphics easily. I selected an infographic template and customized it to present the concept of digital literacy in a clear and visually appealing way.

The infographic explains important topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, and email etiquette. In the first section, digital literacy is described as the ability to use digital technologies to find, evaluate, and communicate information effectively. Another section highlights useful tools such as Google Docs, GitHub, and Google Drive that help students collaborate and manage academic work. I also included safe internet practices such as creating strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and protecting personal information online. In addition, a section on email etiquette explains how students should communicate professionally in academic environments.

Designing the infographic helped me understand how visual communication can simplify complex information and make learning more engaging.

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For my student digital portfolio, I created and updated profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms help students showcase their skills, projects, and professional development.

GitHub is widely used by developers to store and manage coding projects using version control. I created a profile README repository that includes my name, branch, academic year, and learning goals. In the future, I plan to upload programming assignments, personal projects, and internship work to demonstrate my technical skills to potential employers.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that connects students with industry professionals, companies, and recruiters. I updated my education details, including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year. I plan to use LinkedIn to build professional connections, follow technology companies, and apply for internships and job opportunities.

Kaggle is a platform used for practicing data science and machine learning using real datasets. I plan to explore datasets, practice machine learning techniques, and participate in competitions to improve my analytical and problem-solving skills.

Together, these platforms help build a strong digital presence and support my professional development throughout my academic journey.

Task 3 – Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

In this task, I explored coding practice and collaboration platforms that help students improve technical skills and teamwork abilities. I created an account on HackerRank, a popular platform used for learning programming and preparing for coding interviews. I completed a beginner-level challenge called “Solve Me First,” which helped me understand how coding platforms evaluate solutions and provide instant feedback.

Practicing coding problems regularly helps students strengthen their programming knowledge and improve their problem-solving abilities. These platforms are also commonly used by companies to assess technical skills during recruitment.

I also used Google Forms from Google Workspace to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my classmates. The quiz includes five questions related to safe internet practices and digital tools. The responses from the form are automatically stored in a connected Google Sheet, making it easy to collect and analyze data.

These platforms support collaborative learning and practical skill development. Coding practice platforms improve programming skills, while cloud-based tools like Google Forms help students collect information, conduct surveys, and collaborate effectively.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Poor digital communication can sometimes cause misunderstandings in academic or professional environments. For example, if a student sends an email to a professor without a clear subject line, greeting, or explanation, it may appear disrespectful or unprofessional. Such messages can create confusion or leave a negative impression.

Professional email etiquette helps ensure that communication is clear, polite, and respectful. A well-written email should include a clear subject line, proper greeting, structured message, and polite closing. This structure makes it easier for the recipient to understand the purpose of the message.

Learning proper email etiquette is important for students because professional communication skills are essential in both academic and workplace environments. By following these guidelines, students can communicate effectively and maintain a professional digital presence.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching cybercrime, I was surprised to learn how common UPI payment fraud has become in India, especially among students and young internet users. Many people mistakenly believe that scanning a QR code or approving a payment request can help them receive money. Fraudsters take advantage of this misunderstanding to trick victims into sending money instead.

Cybercriminals also impersonate bank representatives or customer support agents to gain people's trust and collect sensitive information. This shows how important digital awareness and caution are when dealing with financial transactions online.

One habit I will personally change is being more careful when receiving unexpected payment requests or banking messages. I will always verify the sender before approving any transaction and avoid clicking suspicious links. I will also encourage others to report cybercrime through the National Cyber Crime Portal or helpline number 1930 if they face such incidents.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in modern education and professional life. Through the different tasks, I learned how to use design tools, create a professional digital portfolio, practice coding skills, communicate effectively through emails, and stay aware of cyber threats. These activities provided practical experience with important digital platforms and tools that students commonly use today. The project also emphasized responsible digital behavior and safe internet practices. Overall, the experience improved my technical knowledge, communication skills, and awareness of cybersecurity, which will be valuable for my academic growth and future career development.

References

Canva – Graphic Design Platform
GitHub – https://github.com
LinkedIn – https://linkedin.com
Kaggle – https://kaggle.com
HackerRank – https://hackerrank.com
Google Forms – Google Workspace
National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in